



MeitY proposes fresh incentives for electronics manufacturers

Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) has proposed fresh incentives to boost electronics manufacturing in India after three major schemes ended last year. Proposals include four to six per cent interest rate subsidy on loans for new investments, renewal of the electronics manufacturing cluster (EMC) scheme and waiver of collateral for

loans taken to set up machinery.

According to an English daily, this move comes after three marquee schemes of the government that were designed to kickstart local electronics manufacturing in India ended in 2018. The fresh proposals have been sent to the finance ministry.

The proposal to provide interest rate subsidy is aimed at making local

manufacturing competitive and attract global companies to set up units in the country. In India, industrial lending rates are higher than those of its competitors including China and Vietnam.

MeitY has also proposed allowing new entrepreneurs to set up manufacturing facilities without having to give personal collateral under the credit guarantee scheme.

India's policy is to focus on export-led growth: Amitabh Kant

NITI Aayog chief executive officer Amitabh Kant has said that India had been pursuing a policy of import substitution so far and, in the future, the country will essentially focus on export-led growth.

At an industry gathering, Kant said India has huge potential to become a global manufacturing hub for electronic products.

National Policy for Electronics 2019 has already identified the export of electronics to be a key area of focus. Kant believes that mobile devices will

be the largest segment, accounting for almost one-third of the country's manufacturing activities.

Kant added that the government has constituted a committee that includes NITI Aayog CEO, finance secretary, DIPP secretary and secretary, MeitY. He emphasised that the government remains committed to creating a very conducive environment for manufacturing electronic products in India.

He also highlighted that efforts are on to make India a five-trillion-dollar economy by 2024.

PMO panel seeks inputs from global companies to make India a manufacturing hub

A high-level panel set up by Prime Minister's Office (PMO) has sought inputs from over a dozen global companies, including Apple, Samsung and Intel, on what they need to make India their manufacturing base. The development underlines India's aggressive push to attract foreign investment by wooing manufacturers away from China.

The panel has met with Taiwanese, Korean, American and European com-

panies recently, and is now working on a report on how to simplify India's domestic policies and attract companies to India as soon as possible, a person briefed on the meeting told the *Economic Times*.

The panel, which is working at breakneck speed to submit its findings to the PMO, is of the opinion that thrust of electronics exports must be on smartphones, another person familiar with the discussions told the daily.

ON THE move

Airtel appoints Rajesh Tapadia as CEO of Nxtra Data

Bharti Airtel has appointed Rajesh Tapadia as chief executive officer (CEO) of its data centre and cloud business, Nxtra Data. Tapadia brings with him a rich experience of more than 24 years with organisations like Netmagic Solutions, Trimax, Global Cloud Xchange, Genpact and Reliance Infocomm.

Shirish Agarwal joins Panasonic India as head of brand and marketing communications

Panasonic India has appointed Shirish Agarwal as head of brand and marketing communications. Spearheading the vertical, Agarwal will be responsible for devising marketing strategies for products/services and driving sustainable growth for the company.

ReNew Power appoints D. Muthukumaran as CFO

Birla group veteran D. Muthukumaran has been appointed as chief financial officer (CFO) of Gurugram-based renewable energy company ReNew Power. Muthukumaran will be responsible for overseeing the company's finance and accounts, legal and corporate finance functions.